

Green Dreams

Adani Green Energy, under Vneet S. Jaain's leadership, is making clean energy affordable through a mix of scale, localisation and digitisation to help meet India's energy goals

By **Anand Adhikari**

► **VNEET S. JAAIN** has an interesting take on the word “impossible”. To the Managing Director of Adani Green Energy Ltd (AGEL), the word simply means “I’m possible”. To the 53-year-old, the refusal to take calculated risks in favour of a safe path translates to succumbing to failure by default. This mindset inspires his daily routine at work, and it has guided him to a successful career over the past two decades.

For instance, after almost one and a half decades with the Delhi-based Jindal Steel & Power Ltd (JSPL), Jaain chose to face fresh challenges, both geographically and professionally, by joining the Adani Group

in Ahmedabad in the mid-2000s. “I was in my comfort zone. I was working very closely with the late O.P. Jindal and his sons. I was actually enjoying more authority because of my association with the family,” explains Jaain. At JSPL, he was exposed to all departments—mining, steel making, rolling mills, power, etc. But he wanted to face new challenges.

Living by his mantra, Jaain packed his bags and left for Ahmedabad when the opportunity arose with the Adani Group. The Jindal Group was well known those days, while the Adani Group was emerging as a new player in the trading, agribusiness, and ports sectors. Not many professionals would have taken the risk of leaving a stable job in a metropolis to shift base to the sleepy city of Ahmedabad to join an emerging player.

In Ahmedabad, Jaain started his innings in the newly set up thermal power vertical. “I was the fourth or fifth employee of the energy vertical,” recalls Jaain, who joined as Vice President in 2006. He was quickly elevated to the post of CEO at Adani Power Ltd; this was followed by a stint as CEO of Adani Transmission Ltd (now called Adani Energy Solutions Ltd). Later, he took over as CEO of Adani Infra (India) Ltd, before moving to AGEL in 2015 as a Non-executive Director.

Under Jaain's leadership, AGEL has grown to become one of the largest renewable energy firms in India, with a current wind and solar project portfolio of 20.80 GW. AGEL's operating portfolio is 8.47 GW, the largest in India. The firm has also sewed up long-term power purchase agreements with central and state governments, as well as with government-backed enterprises. Jaain, the winner in the Clean Energy category of the BT-PwC India's Best CEOs ranking this year, says his contribution is minimal, as the Adani ecosystem contributed to the success of the green energy business. “I am executing my leader Gautam Adani's vision,” he says modestly.

Clean Energy VNEET S. JAAIN*

MD, ADANI GREEN ENERGY

Revenue from operations	FY23	7,776
	9MFY24	6,693
Profit before tax	FY23	1,367
	9MFY24	1,035
Profit after tax	FY23	973
	9MFY24	950
	FY23 RoE (%)	27.52
	Market Cap	3,04,688.7

● Data is on a consolidated basis; all figures in ₹ crore except RoE; 9MFY24: April-December 2023

● M-cap as of February 23, 2024; *CEO till May 2023

● **Source** ACE Equity, BSE